PANELTEC PTY LTD
P O Box 148 Kings Meadows, TAS 7249
ABN: 12 128 689 412

SWMS-64

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**WORKING ON WATER SERVICES/MAINS (INCULDING CONTROLS FOR ISOLATING, DEWATERING AND RECHARGING PIPES)**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:**		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023		31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability: L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U Unlikely
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS – WORKING ON WATER SERVICES/MAINS WITH PRESSURE

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Planning	Unforeseen event. Physical injury.	**1**	1. An emergency rescue plan must be completed for each task whether trenching is involved or not. 2. Confirm that the closest hydrant or scour to the work site is accessible and operational by physically testing. 3. Release the pressure in the line when caulking/packing valves as necessary. 4. Double/secondary isolation is required where the initial isolation point is ineffective, or a risk assessment has determined additional control measures required. i.e. the proximity of valve to excavation/ground disturbance increases risk of failure of couplings at isolation point. 5. Review, Acceptance and sign off shut-down plan by TasWater (TW).	TasWater & Worker(s)	**2**
Operation of Valves New & Existing	Public safety. Physical injury and effect on dialysis patients	**1**	1. Traffic management issues for vehicles and pedestrians must be addressed in accordance with the Manual of Uniform Traffic Devices (MUTCD+ Part3. 2. Refer to Dialysis patients list (if applicable)	TasWater & Worker(s)	**2**
De-pressurisation of services/ mains	Pressure water Mains failure during depressurising Physical injury.	**1**	1. Notify the Control Centre before operating valves to reduce pressure for caulking/ packing valves as necessary. 2. Operate valves as per Control Centre instructions. 3. Ensure the mains pressure is reduced sufficiently to complete caulking/ packing valves as necessary 4. Notify Control Centre when main or pipes has been depressurized sufficiently to safely undertake work.	Worker	**2**
Re-pressurising service/mains	Uncontrolled pressure release. Physical injury.	**1**	1. Recharge the main at a rate that avoids dirty water & damage from water hammer or air pressure build up in main by use of scours valves, hydrants, air valves & Hot-tap TPFNR. 2. Scour the main until water visibility is clean (e.g. If water is milky, it is a sign of air still in main - keep flushing until water is clear). 3. If contaminant is in main (e.g. sewerage mains scour should be run for at least 45 minutes). (Follow shut down/flow control plans with permit to work). 4. Notify Control Centre that service/main has been brought to	Worker	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			optimum network pressure. 5. Ensure that there is no visible signs of environmental impact (e.g. slit, sediment or sewer overflow flowing to stormwater or large amounts of water flowing into rivers, creeks or land overflows).		
Environment	Environment damage to rivers, creeks, stormwater, drains & land	**1**	1. Ensure that site is restored to original condition.	Worker	**2**

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS – ISOLATE, DEWATER AND RECHARGE PIPES (For tasks not approved to be completed under pressure)

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Planning	Unsafe worksite. Physical injury.	**1**	1. Identify location of relevant zones and valves. 2. Confirm Valve Operator competency. 3. Develop Shut Plan or refer to pre-prepared Shut Plan/Control Plan	Worker	**2**
Operation of Valves	Public safety. Physical injury and effect on dialysis patients	**1**	1. At sites where there is heavy pedestrian access, must comply with MUTCD Manual Part3. 2. Refer to Dialysis patients list.	Worker	**2**
De-pressurisation of the mains	Pressure water Mains failure during depressurising Physical injury.	**1**	1. Notify the Control Centre before operating valves. 2. Operate valves as advised (for responsive work) or as per shut down / flow control plan with permit to work issued with work folder.(NOTE: If shutting valves due to burst ensure vales are shut slowly as not to cause water hammer through the network). Ensure that the LOTO register is completed for each valve operated and a Valve Closed tag attached to each. 3. Ensure the mains are no longer under pressure and sufficiently dewatered for work to begin by installing a hydrant standpipe (or any other means available e.g. scour valve, service air valve, Hottap TPFNR to depressurize) 4. Ensure that all environment controls are in place as per shut down/flow control plan 5. Notify Control Centre when main or pipes has been depressurized & dewatered to safely undertake work.	Worker	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Recharging mains	Uncontrolled pressure release. failure during recharge. Physical injury.	**1**	1. Notify Control Centre of intention to operate valves. 2. Recharge the main at a rate that avoids dirty water & damage from water hammer or air pressure build up in main by use of scours valves, hydrants, air valves & Hottap, TPFNR. 3. Ensure that the LOTO register is completed for each valve operated and the Valve Closed tag removed. 4. Scour the main until water visibility is clean (e.g. If water is milky it is a sign of air still in main keep flushing until water is clear). 5. If contaminant is in main (e.g. sewerage mains scour should be run for at least 45 minutes). Follow shut down/flow control plans with permit to work). 6. Ensure all vales are returned to normal operation position once recharge is complete.	Worker	**2**
Environment	Environment damage to rivers, creeks, stormwater, drains & land	**1**	1. Ensure there is no visible signs of environmental impact (e.g. slit, sediment or sewer overflow flowing to stormwater or large amounts of water flowing into rivers, creeks or land overflows). 2. Check for erosion or damage to environment & if possible minimise or control the damage as per Environmental Management Plan. 3. Ensure that site is restored to original condition.	Worker	**2**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle License's (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators license's or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

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WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.